Mahindra University **HS 1101 – Module 2**
École Centrale School of Engineering **Worksheet 2.2**

Name: **Roll No:** **Batch:**

Part I – Read the paragraph below.

A. Underline the topic sentence and write the main idea of the paragraph in your own words.

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Dewey championed learning by doing, also known as experiential learning. He observed that children learn better when they are actively engaged, because they are immersed in the present and not a distant future, such as final exams. In biology students don't read books, but instead grow plants, harvest fruits and then feed them to snails to see what happens. Sometimes things work out, sometimes accidents happen — whatever the outcome, the students take notes of their observations and form rich memorable experiences. At the end of each class they summarize their learning and turn to discussions.

B. Choose two supporting sentences from the paragraph. How does each sentence support the main idea?

Supporting sentence 1: _____

Supporting sentence 2: _____

Part II - Supporting details are used for different purposes.

Type	Purpose
Reason	to explain why something is true, important, necessary, etc.
Example	to give a specific case or instance to illustrate a main idea
Facts / Statistics	to provide factual evidence or measurable information
Explanation	to clarify, develop or make an idea easier to understand
Description	to give specific details about the characteristics, features, or nature of someone, something or an idea
Analysis	to show the writer's thinking about the topic.

Part III – Identify the type of supporting detail used in the paragraphs given below. Write your answer in the space provided.

1. Failure is an unavoidable part of pursuing any professional goal. In a survey of college students, nearly three out of four respondents reported experiencing academic failure or disappointment at some point in their studies. ( ) For example, a student may perform poorly in an examination, receive negative feedback on a presentation, or have a project rejected. ( ) Such experiences can involve disappointment, embarrassment, self-doubt, frustration, and the fear of trying again. ( ) Failure, however, does not necessarily mean that a person lacks ability; rather, it can show that a particular approach did not work and needs to be changed. ( ) People can learn from failure because it encourages them to examine their mistakes, identify their weaknesses, and consider better ways of approaching a problem. Therefore, failure can become a useful part of learning because the experience of not succeeding can lead to reflection, improvement, and greater persistence**.**

2. Reading is more than a way of collecting information; it is a means of expanding our understanding of ourselves and the world. Regular reading develops vocabulary, comprehension, and critical-thinking skills. ( ) For instance, reading a story about a refugee can introduce us to experiences of displacement that we may never have encountered personally. ( ) By following a character's thoughts, emotions, and struggles, readers can understand how people respond to situations that are different from their own. ( ) Moreover, reading can make us more open-minded, as it exposes us to unfamiliar cultures, beliefs, and perspectives. ( ) When readers compare a character's choices with their own experiences, they may begin to question their assumptions and develop independent opinions. ( ) A book can become a window into another world, filled with unfamiliar places, voices, conflicts, and possibilities. Hence, reading is not simply an academic activity; it is a way of developing empathy, imagination, and a deeper understanding of life.

Part IV – Read the topic sentences and answer the questions given below.

1. Topic sentence: Schools should give students more opportunities to learn outside the classroom.

Which sentence(s) would be effective supporting details?

a) Learning outside the classroom can help students connect abstract ideas to real situations.
b) For example, a biology class could study the plants and insects in a local park.
c) A 2024 study found that students who regularly participated in outdoor learning showed higher levels of engagement.
d) Outdoor learning can also encourage students to work collaboratively.

Which sentence would you choose as the most effective supporting detail? Why?

2. Decide what type(s) of support would be effective for the topic sentences given below. Give reasons for your choice.

i) Topic sentence: The rapid development of artificial intelligence is changing the way students approach their work.

☐ a reason	☐ an example	☐ facts/statistics
☐ an explanation	☐ description	☐ analysis

ii) Topic sentence: Social media can influence the way teenagers see themselves.

a) Social media gives teenagers opportunities to present particular aspects of their lives to friends, classmates, and people they may not know personally.
b) When teenagers repeatedly encounter carefully edited images of other people's appearance and lifestyles, they may begin comparing themselves with standards that are difficult or impossible to achieve.
c) A 2023 survey of teenagers found that many young people use social media several times a day and consider it an important part of their social lives.

iii) Topic sentence: Learning through projects can make academic ideas more meaningful to students.

a) Students may have to plan their work, make decisions about how to approach a problem, and adjust their plans when something does not work.
b) For example, students studying water quality might collect samples from a nearby stream and use scientific concepts to investigate what they find.
c) Projects allow students to see how concepts learned in class can be used to investigate questions or solve problems beyond a textbook exercise.

Part V – Choose any two topic sentences. For each topic sentence, list what kind of supporting details you would use to develop it into a complete paragraph. Give reasons for your choice.

1. Topic sentence: Interdisciplinary education allows students to build on what they already know and strengthens their understanding

What types of support would you choose? _____

Write two supporting sentences based on your choice.

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2. Topic sentence: Technology can improve learning but it cannot replace effective teaching.

What types of support would you choose? _____

Write two supporting sentences based on your choice.

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3. Topic sentence: Being able to question information is an essential part of learning.

What types of support would you choose? _____

Write two supporting sentences based on your choice.

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